

SEARCH AUDIT

Custom Window Decorators

customwindowdecorators.com

DATE

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PREPARED BY

Five Points Digital Studio

A FIVE POINTS COMMISSION

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The standing of the search estate



Custom Window Decorators runs a WordPress site with competent baseline hygiene – a self-referencing canonical, a Yoast sitemap, clean meta and a single H1 – but the fundamentals that win local search are not yet in place. The homepage targets "custom windows", which reads as window replacement rather than the window treatments the business sells, and the site carries no LocalBusiness structured data despite being a showroom-led company with two service areas. Three quick wins sit in the robots and image layers. Technical and performance, the layer the redesign brief already flags as dated and not mobile-optimised, is owned by the partner audit and pending.

TOP PRIORITIES

- Retarget the homepage and core pages from "custom windows" to window-treatment intent.

QUICK WINS

- Declare the sitemap in robots.txt.
- Remove the 30-second crawl-delay.

- Add LocalBusiness structured data and align it to the Google Business Profile.
- Commission the web-quality audit to close the technical and mobile gaps the redesign brief already names.
- Add descriptive alt text to the nine homepage images that lack it.

Search Audit

FIVE POINTS

Custom Window Decorators

How this audit was conducted

Scope

The live customwindowdecorators.com, audited on the findability and content layers – crawlability and indexation, on-page, content quality and E-E-A-T, and international. The homepage, the products and services page, robots.txt and the XML sitemap were sampled. Technical and performance was out of scope for this half.

Tools used

Direct retrieval of the live HTML, response headers, robots.txt and the XML sitemap. The server-rendered Yoast schema graph was read from source. No paid crawler was used on this pass.

Limitations

Search Console and analytics access was not available, so index coverage, impressions and the queries already driving traffic could not be confirmed and are inferred from the live markup. Schema was read from the server-rendered Yoast graph and should be confirmed with the Rich Results Test before delivery. The crawl was sampled rather than exhaustive. Technical and performance findings await the web-quality audit.

FINDINGS

What the audit surfaced

Findings are grouped by layer and carry a fixed field set – the issue, its impact, the layer it sits in, the supporting evidence, the prescribed fix and a priority marker. The priority marker maps to the action plan that follows.

01 Crawl and Index

The XML sitemap is not declared in robots.txt		MEDIUM IMPACT
		CRAWL AND INDEX
		P3 QUICK WIN
ISSUE	The sitemap index exists and is reachable, but robots.txt does not point crawlers to it, so discovery relies on manual submission alone.	
EVIDENCE	/robots.txt returns only a user-agent rule and a crawl-delay, with no Sitemap line. The index is live at /sitemap.xml and lists four sub-sitemaps.	
FIX	Add Sitemap: https://customwindowdecorators.com/sitemap.xml to robots.txt so every crawler discovers the full URL set.	
PRIORITY	P3 Quick win – a one-line change that improves crawl discovery immediately.	

A 30-second crawl-delay throttles discovery

LOW IMPACT

CRAWL AND INDEX

P3 QUICK WIN

ISSUE	robots.txt sets a 30-second crawl-delay. Google ignores the directive, but Bing and other engines honour it, slowing how quickly new and changed pages are seen.
EVIDENCE	/robots.txt contains Crawl-delay: 30.
FIX	Remove the crawl-delay unless a server-load reason requires it. The site is small enough not to need throttling.
PRIORITY	P3 Quick win – removes an unnecessary brake on non-Google crawlers.

Tag and category archives are indexable and in the sitemap

MEDIUM IMPACT

CRAWL AND INDEX

P3 QUICK WIN

ISSUE	The sitemap includes tag and category archive sets. On a small site these archives are usually thin and near-duplicate, diluting crawl focus away from the service pages that earn revenue.
EVIDENCE	/sitemap.xml lists category-sitemap.xml and post_tag-sitemap.xml.
FIX	Assess whether the archives carry unique value. Where they do not, set them to noindex and drop them from the sitemap to concentrate crawl budget on service and location pages.
PRIORITY	P3 Quick win – tightens the indexable set without touching primary content.

The homepage keyword targets the wrong intent

HIGH IMPACT

ON-PAGE

P2 HIGH-IMPACT

ISSUE

The homepage is optimised for "custom windows", which reads as window manufacture or replacement. The business sells window treatments – blinds, shades and drapes. The site is competing for the wrong query and the wrong visitor.

EVIDENCE

The homepage title is Custom Windows in Lewiston, Maine | Custom Window Decorators Inc and the og:title matches. The product range is window treatments, not windows.

FIX

Retarget the homepage and core pages to window-treatment intent, for example "Custom Window Treatments in Lewiston, Maine | Blinds, Shades and Drapes", and align the H1 and meta description to match.

PRIORITY

P2 High-impact – intent alignment governs which searches the site can ever win.

Nine of seventeen homepage images lack descriptive alt text

MEDIUM IMPACT

ON-PAGE

P3 QUICK WIN

ISSUE

Image alt text is missing or empty on more than half of the homepage images, costing image-search visibility and accessibility, and wasting a natural place for relevant terms.

EVIDENCE

Of seventeen homepage images, two have no alt attribute and seven carry an empty alt value.

FIX

Add descriptive, naturally phrased alt text to the showroom and product imagery. Leave only genuinely decorative images with empty alt.

PRIORITY

P3 Quick win – contained, no design change, immediate accessibility and image-search benefit.

The homepage carries an unusually high internal-link count

LOW IMPACT

ON-PAGE

P4 LONG-TERM

ISSUE	The homepage exposes 112 internal links, largely through the menu and footer. A link count this high flattens the site hierarchy and spreads ranking signal thinly across pages of unequal importance.
EVIDENCE	A parse of the live homepage counts 112 internal links.
FIX	Trim the menu and footer to the priority service and location pages so internal linking concentrates signal where it matters.
PRIORITY	P4 Long-term – best handled within the redesign rather than as a patch.

03 Content and E-E-A-T

No LocalBusiness structured data is present

HIGH IMPACT

CONTENT AND E-E-A-T

P2 HIGH-IMPACT

ISSUE	For a showroom-led local company, LocalBusiness schema is the single highest-value structured-data signal for local search and map visibility. It is absent from the schema graph.
EVIDENCE	The server-rendered Yoast schema graph contains WebPage, WebSite and BreadcrumbList but no LocalBusiness or HomeAndConstructionBusiness type. Confirm with the Rich Results Test before delivery.
FIX	Add LocalBusiness schema carrying name, address, phone, geo-coordinates, opening hours and service area, with sameAs pointing to the Google Business Profile.
PRIORITY	P2 High-impact – the core local-search signal for a business that lives on local intent.

Thirty-seven years of heritage are underused as trust signals

MEDIUM IMPACT

CONTENT AND E-E-A-T

P3 QUICK WIN

ISSUE	The company dates to 1987 and carries premium brand lines, but that experience, those credentials and customer reviews are not structured as the experience and trust signals Google rewards.
EVIDENCE	The business was founded in 1987 and stocks Hunter Douglas and other recognised lines. Credentials, reviews and an authoritative About presence are not surfaced as trust signals on key pages.
FIX	Surface the heritage, the certifications, the brand affiliations and customer reviews on the homepage and service pages, and add Organisation and Review schema.
PRIORITY	P3 Quick win – the proof already exists and only needs surfacing.

Two service areas share one set of pages

MEDIUM IMPACT

CONTENT AND E-E-A-T

P3 QUICK WIN

ISSUE	The business serves Lewiston and a second location in Topsham, yet local intent is concentrated on a single set of pages, limiting visibility in each distinct market.
EVIDENCE	The site references The Window Dresser location in Topsham alongside the Lewiston showroom.
FIX	Build a dedicated, uniquely written location page for each showroom, each with its own NAP, an embedded map and genuinely local content.
PRIORITY	P3 Quick win – unlocks a second local market the business already operates in.

Not applicable. The site serves a single en-US locale, so hreflang, multi-locale canonicalisation and international sitemaps are not in scope. This was checked and cleared.

05 **Technical and Performance**

Pending the web-quality audit, the partner skill that owns speed, Core Web Vitals, accessibility and security. The redesign brief already records the current site as dated and not mobile-optimised, so this layer is expected to carry material findings. It will be completed and folded into this same deliverable once web-quality ships.

Findings	FIVE POINTS	Custom Window Decorators
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ACTION PLAN

The prioritised sequence of work

The plan is ordered by priority rather than by layer. Work descends from the critical caps that gate everything else, through the high-impact moves, the quick wins and finally the long-term architecture.

P1 CRITICAL

P2 HIGH-IMPACT

P3 QUICK WIN

P4 LONG-TERM

P1 CRITICAL

No critical blocks found

- Nothing is holding the site out of the index. Indexation, canonicalisation and meta robots are sound, so work begins at the high-impact tier.

P2 HIGH-IMPACT

Fix intent and local signals

- Retarget the homepage and core pages to window-treatment intent, aligning title, H1 and meta description.
- Add LocalBusiness structured data and align it to the Google Business Profile.

P3 QUICK WIN

Ship the immediate gains

- Declare the sitemap in robots.txt and remove the crawl-delay.
- Add descriptive alt text to the homepage images that lack it.
- Surface heritage, credentials and reviews as trust signals, and add Organisation and Review schema.
- Build a dedicated location page for each of the two showrooms.
- Set thin tag and category archives to noindex and drop them from the sitemap.

P4 LONG-TERM

Resolve in the redesign

- Trim the homepage internal-link sprawl so signal concentrates on priority pages.

Action Plan

FIVE POINTS

Custom Window Decorators

NEXT STEPS

Where this goes from here

Five Points is already engaged on the redesign of this site, so these findings do not sit on a shelf. The keyword retarget and the LocalBusiness schema land in the rebuild, the robots and image fixes ship at once, and the web-quality audit completes the technical picture. The recommended next step is to authorise the web-quality pass so the full technical layer joins this same report, then sequence the fixes into the redesign. Pricing for the expanded engagement is named from the Five Points offer suite.

Five Points builds the search infrastructure a singular brand owns and compounds. This audit is the survey. The build is the commission.

Five Points Digital Studio – customwindowdecorators.com

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